Epilogue

I am neither a writer nor an author, but a sportsman with passion, who has poured his heart out in this book. Although I am not a man of words, I hope this book can inspire the youth to take up sports and strive to excel.

I am proud of the fact I am a self-made man. My philosophy is very simple: ‘The lines on our palms do not decide our future, *kambakht* , we, too, have a say in it.’ Hard work can change destiny as I know only too well —my entire life has been dedicated to it. My early years were a struggle, but as I gradually started to achieve results, my name and fame grew. I won competitions and medals, except for the elusive Olympic gold, which I will always regret, and yet I have always been content because I kept trying .

My final words would be: life as a sportsperson is hard, and there will certainly be times when you might be tempted to quit, or take shortcuts— but remember there are no shortcuts to success. At such times you should try and derive inspiration from this Urdu couplet:

Mita de apni hasti ko agar koi martaba chahe,
ki dana khak may mil kar gul-e-gulzar hota hai

Destroy your entire existence if you want to reach the zenith,
’Cos a seed has to become one with the dust to sprout and blossom into a flower.